

Question 29 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

An organisation has an appraisal system but employees report that it does not help their development. Apply HRD principles to improve the appraisal process.

Answer

The problem is typically an administrative/evaluative appraisal without developmental design. HRD principles suggest redesign, not merely a new form.

- 1. Clarify purpose:** State that appraisal is primarily for development (goals, feedback, IDP), with rewards as a separate but linked use.
- 2. Role clarity and joint goal setting:** Begin with agreed KRAs/competencies so review is fair and learning-focused.
- 3. Behavioural, evidence-based feedback:** Train managers to give specific examples, not vague labels.
- 4. Mandatory counselling discussion:** Protect time for two-way dialogue; ban 'form-signing in the corridor'.
- 5. Individual development plan:** Every review must end with training, coaching or stretch-job actions and follow-up dates.
- 6. Link to other subsystems:** Feed gaps to TNA; use potential data for career talk.
- 7. Climate safeguards:** Reduce fear (no public humiliation, some self-appraisal, appeal on process).
- 8. Evaluate the appraisal itself:** Survey whether employees found it useful; hold managers accountable for development quality, not only timely form submission.

Conclusion. Applying these HRD principles converts appraisal from a ritual of judgement into a genuine development subsystem.